

# KIVIN HEIDEN

## Game Programmer

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### CAREER OBJECTIVE

Passionate Game Developer specializing in Unreal Engine, with a strong foundation in Game Programming and 2D/3D development. Proficient in C++ and C#, experienced in building gameplay systems, UI, multiplayer features, and optimized mechanics using both Blueprints and native C++ workflows. Familiar with Unity and GitHub, and seeking a full-time opportunity to create engaging, high-quality player experiences.

### PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead Gameplay Programmer

March 2026 - Present

WRKS Games

Worked on Lord of Kensai, a city-builder developed in Unreal Engine 5 using C++ and Blueprints, progressing from Gameplay Programmer Intern to Lead Gameplay Programmer. Contributed to core gameplay systems and UI while later leading the gameplay programming team, driving major bug fixes, refactoring, and system improvements.

- Developed core gameplay systems including Save/Load, Grid Management, Building Placement & Construction, Simulation, Drone Logistics, Road Generation, and Top-Down Camera systems.
- Led development and refactoring of major UI systems including Factions, HUD, Quests, Tutorials, Settings, Legislation, popups, dialogs, and reusable widgets.
- Led gameplay programming tasks, technical problem-solving, bug fixing, code reviews, and architectural improvements while establishing modular, reusable, and scalable systems.

Unreal Game Programmer - Internship

August 2025 - March 2026

Cyrus 365

Worked as a Game Developer Intern at Cyrus 365, contributing to gameplay mechanics and core system implementation. Involved in multiplayer features, API-driven JSON workflows, and UI development using C++ widgets.

- Contributed to gameplay mechanics development and core system implementation using Unreal Engine C++.
- Implemented and tested multiplayer features, including networking workflows and player interactions.
- Developed API-driven JSON systems and built UI elements using C++ widgets for dynamic in-game functionality.

Gameplay Programmer - Internship

March 2025 - July 2025

Arcanion

Worked as a Gameplay Programming Intern at Arcanion, where I was responsible for implementing core gameplay systems, designing interactive logic in Unreal Engine, and integrating 3D assets into functional game environments.

- Developed a custom C++ player character from scratch, omitting default camera components to support a fully tailored camera control system via Blueprints.
- Set up AI dodge behavior, allowing characters to dynamically avoid the player's line of sight based on difficulty levels and animation triggers
- Collaborated through Git version control, ensuring modular code structure and clean commits during team development.

### EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Game Programming

ICAT College of Design & Media - July 2023 - March 2026

### SKILLS

- Unreal Engine (Blueprints & C++)
  - Aseprite
- Unity 3D (C#)
  - Adobe Photoshop
- Git & Github
  - Diversion
- Networking (Unreal Online Services & Photon)
  - Debugging & Optimization
- Critical Thinking & Problem Solving

## PROJECTS

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### Monster Chef - Unreal Engine (C++)

July 2025 - August 2025

- Developed a cozy cooking game in Unreal Engine with C++, featuring burger assembly and dynamic customer orders
- Designed and programmed UMG-based UI with C++ integration, handling order display, ingredient management, and customer satisfaction feedback

### Santa's Journey - Unreal Engine (Blueprints)

December 2024 - January 2025

- Crafted immersive festive levels featuring illusion-based mechanics, guiding Santa through cleverly disguised paths.
- Engineered perspective-driven puzzles using orthographic tricks, requiring players to align viewpoints to uncover hidden routes.

### Rogue Rush — Unreal Engine (Blueprints)

November 2024 - December 2024

- Crafted immersive festive levels featuring illusion-based mechanics, guiding Santa through cleverly disguised paths.
- Engineered perspective-driven puzzles using orthographic tricks, requiring players to align viewpoints to uncover hidden routes.

### Zenith — Unreal Engine 5 (C++)

March 2024 - September 2024

- Developed a multiplayer shooter in Unreal Engine 5 using C++ and Blueprints, implementing core gameplay systems and networked player interactions.
- Integrated Steam Online Subsystem for multiplayer functionality and developed a custom comic-style cel-shading material for the game's visual style.

### Tower Fall — Unity (C#)

August 2024 - September 2024

- Developed a fast-paced 3D arcade game inspired by Helix Jump, implementing tower generation, player movement, obstacle avoidance, and progression systems.
- Programmed gameplay mechanics and interactions in Unity using C#, focusing on responsive controls and timing-based challenges.

### Escape Blitz — Unity (C#)

February 2024 - March 2024

- Developed a 2D multiplayer puzzle game using Unity, C#, and Photon, implementing networked player interactions and cooperative gameplay mechanics.
  - Designed team-based challenges requiring player coordination and communication, with multiplayer synchronization and gameplay logic.
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